

Week 4

Emotions and Moods

How affect shapes service quality, decision quality and continuous improvement

Postgraduate Diploma in Total Quality Management

Prepare → Learn → Apply → Discuss → Assess → Reflect



Learning outcomes

- 1 Differentiate emotions from moods and explain workplace relevance.
- 2 Explain emotional labor, affective events and mood contagion.
- 3 Analyze how affect influences service, safety and decision quality.
- 4 Apply emotional intelligence and regulation strategies.
- 5 Connect emotions and moods to quality performance indicators.

Core question

When emotions and moods change at work, what happens to quality behavior?

8

tracked activities

4

quality links

1

mini case

Emotions vs. moods: what is the difference?

Emotions

More intense, shorter-lived, and usually linked to a specific event. They focus attention and trigger immediate responses.

Moods

Less intense, more diffuse, and longer-lasting. They shape interpretation, energy and tone across the day.

Both influence behavior before people fully rationalize what happened.

Why affect matters for quality performance



Attention

People notice or miss details depending on stress, fatigue and mood.

Communication

Tone shapes employee voice, escalation and customer recovery.

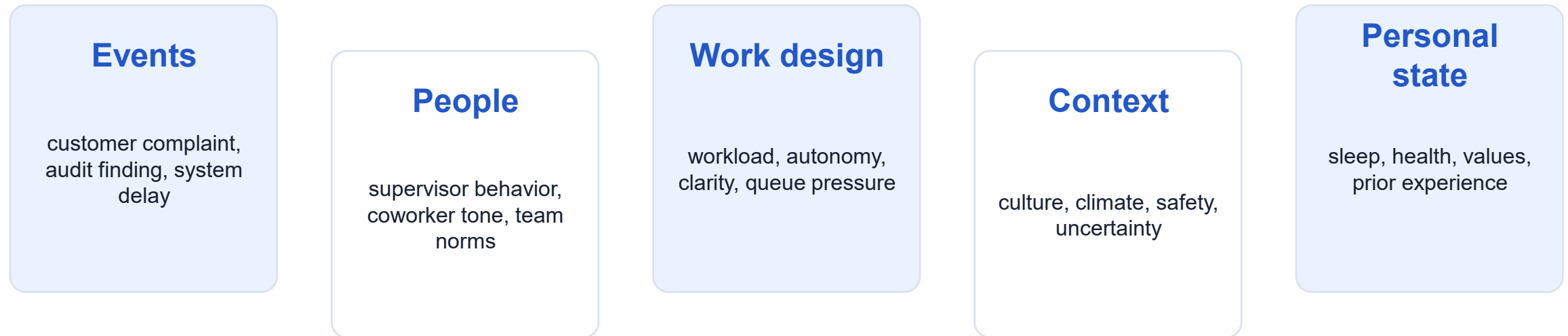
Judgment

Affect changes risk perception and decision speed.

Consistency

Stable emotional climate supports reliable service routines.

Common sources of workplace emotions and moods



Quality implication: treat recurring emotional triggers as process signals, not only personal issues.

Affective Events Theory: from event to quality behavior



Managerial takeaway: improve the event stream and the emotional response system.

Emotional labor in service and quality roles



Surface acting

Changing the visible display while the inner feeling remains different.

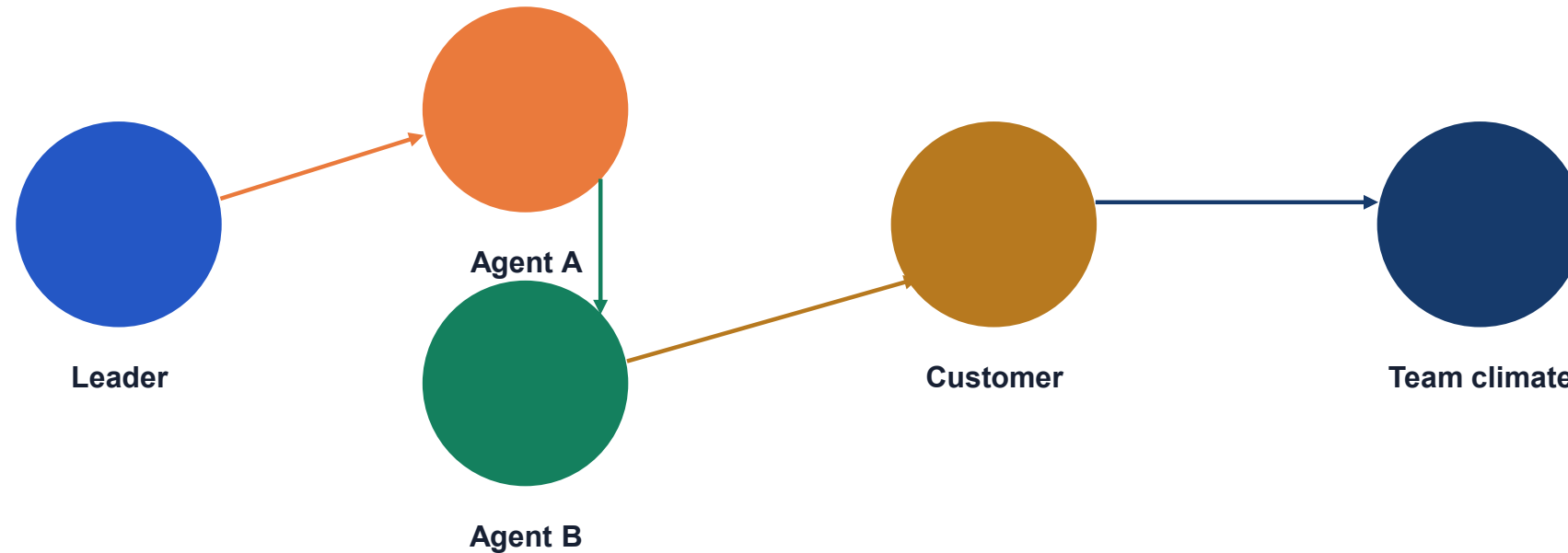
Deep acting

Trying to genuinely reframe the situation and change the felt emotion.

Quality risk

If emotional labor is unsupported, employees may rush, avoid voice, detach from customers or skip verification.

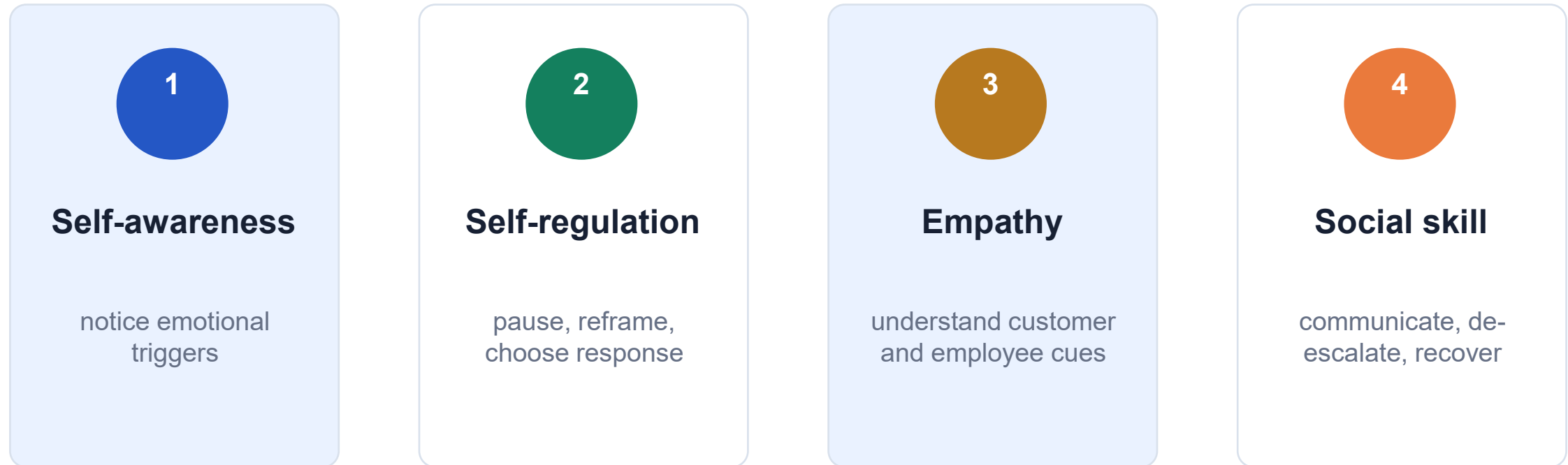
Mood contagion: emotions spread through teams



Control point

Supervisors can interrupt contagion through calm tone, structured huddles, recovery scripts and visible support.

Emotional intelligence for quality leaders



Quality leadership starts before the technical decision: it starts with emotional clarity.

Regulation toolbox: individual + system controls

Reappraisal

reinterpret the event before reacting

Pause protocol

slow down high-risk responses

Checklists

protect accuracy under stress

Service recovery scripts

give employees words for difficult moments

Huddles

reset team mood and workload expectations

Escalation paths

make support easy before conflict grows

How to measure the affect–quality connection

Customer indicators

complaints, recovery time, satisfaction comments

Process indicators

rework, defects, verification errors, queue time

People indicators

absence, turnover intention, voice, engagement

Safety indicators

near misses, escalation delay, skipped controls

Use emotional data ethically: look for patterns, not blame.

Mini case: The Frustrated Service Desk

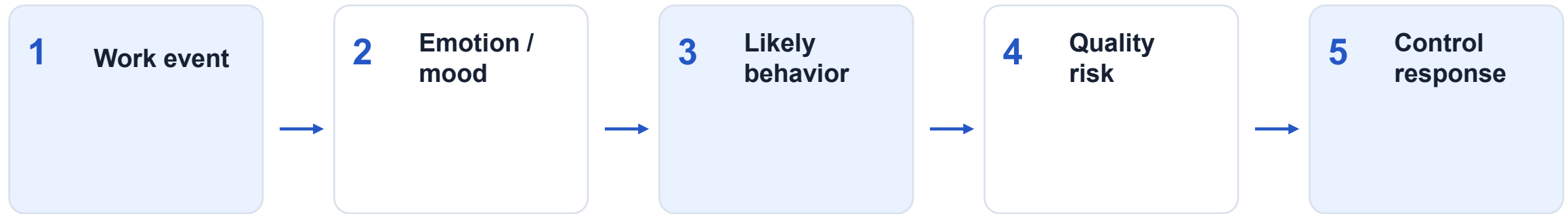


Situation

Repeated system delays frustrate employees. Team tone becomes sharper, complaints rise and verification steps are skipped.

- 1 Which emotions and moods are visible?
- 2 How is mood contagion affecting the team?
- 3 What quality risks arise from emotional spillover?
- 4 What should the supervisor do immediately?

In-class activity: Emotion-to-Quality Mapping



Deliverable

Complete one map for a real work event and propose one practical control that protects quality.

Knowledge check and assignment

Knowledge check

5 multiple-choice questions covering:

- emotions vs. moods
- emotional labor
- affective events theory
- emotional intelligence
- mood contagion

Assignment

Write 500–700 words analyzing one work situation where emotions or moods affected service quality, safety, teamwork or decision quality. Recommend individual and managerial controls.

Week 4 key takeaways



Affect is data

Emotions and moods provide early warning signals about work design and climate.

Quality is behavioral

Service quality, safety and reliability depend on attention, tone and judgment.

Leaders regulate systems

The strongest response combines emotional intelligence with process controls.

Measure patterns

Use indicators ethically to improve conditions, not to blame individuals.

Next week: Personality and Values